



fellows fellowssc <fellows@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Rosa Leon

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Sat, Feb 29, 2020 at 12:27 PM

Reply-To: rosaleon@pennmedicine.upenn.edu

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Rosa Leon

Gender

Female

Nationalityrosaleon@pennmedicine.upenn.edu**Email**rosaleon@pennmedicine.upenn.edu**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

July 2020

City, state, and country of residence

Philadelphia, PA, USA

University education

Ph.D./Neuroscience/University of Pennsylvania/2015-2020

Bachelors of Science/Biology and Neuroscience/Syracuse University/2010-2014

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

I received my first years of formal education in Peru, where I saw first-hand how children my own age didn't always have access to school. It was one of the first times I remember feeling guilt over something I had no control over. Education being an opportunity that is not afforded to everyone has since been an injustice of personal sentiment. After all, education is invaluable and it should not be a privilege.

My high school specialized in STEM, it was there that I completed my first research project and was encouraged to pursue a career in science. That school was the biggest contributor in shaping my academic path. Being a direct benefactor of a STEM program, I'm cognizant of the benefits and powerful impact access to a STEM program can have.

I want to be a Science Corps fellow because their mission to bring STEM programs to those in need is a cause I believe in and one I want to contribute to. I have been extremely lucky in my educational endeavors, now I want to use my skills to help provide academic opportunities that can help students excel. I believe Science Corps can help me do just that.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

Over the past five years, I have obtained a broad range of classroom experience. I have taught neuroscience to students K-12 through various outreach programs, I have helped design 60-minute lectures for high school students, I've run weekly recitations/labs for undergraduates (Introduction to Neuroscience), and I have designed and presented 90-minute interactive workshops to graduate students. This array of experiences have enabled me to think on my feet, manage a room, communicate effectively, make classroom material accessible, and appropriately assess my student's needs. Teaching in diverse environments, to all age groups, has taught me versatility when communicating with students. By creating my own content for lectures and workshops I have learned to incorporate different teaching methodologies.

Working as a head TA I have acquired organizational and course management skills. My main responsibility as a head TA was to schedule and oversee all aspects of the course (recitations, reviews, grading, student concerns, etc). I also made edits to curriculum, helped write exams, and finalize grades. I understand the workload and skills required to successfully manage a course. Given my experiences, drive, and aptitude I feel equipped to become a Science Corps Fellow.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

In science education
In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

Ultimately, I want a career centered on an education-driven movement. I want to help move STEM education in a positive direction. To achieve that I need to expand my knowledge and skillset and to do that I need to venture outside of academia.

Following graduation, and hopefully Science Corps, I want to work as a healthcare consultant. I want to use the next 2-5 years outside of academia to learn more about how the world works on a larger scale, analyze problems through a different lens, sharpen my soft-skills, and continue to improve my problem-solving abilities.

There are a lot of systemic problems within academia (lack of replicability, financial biases, poor bench to media communication, etc) and the education system as a whole (accessibility, integration of technology, financial burden, etc). In ten years, I want to be working to help combat some of these issues. I will be seeking out opportunities where I am most needed, whether that is in education, government, or policy. I hope to be able to use my scientific background and consulting/business experience to help make academia/education an even better experience for future generations.

CV/Resumé

[CV_Leon_Rosa.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

A friend or colleague

Any extra comment or message.

I am seeking a teaching position for the Fall of 2020, preferably at CVIF. I would also love to learn more about the developing placement sites in Belize and South Africa.

I had trouble entering my nationality. When I entered "American" I got an error message asking me to enter a valid email. That is why I enter my email in that slot.

Sent from Science Corps